Murder Mystery

Dinner Party 2026



Cary Crates

The Meridian Museum

October 30, 2026 / Private player packet / 1 of 12

Cary Crates

Senior Art Handler & Installation Specialist

Cary knows which crate holds a masterpiece and which one holds the extension cords. Cary is the person trusted to move objects worth more than the building without dropping either.

- Works daily with **Chip Patina**.
- Has developed mutual respect with **Frank Lloyd Wrong** despite arguing about impossible installation drawings.
- **Al Baster** likes Cary because Cary actually knows how heavy sculpture is.

ACTING TIPS

Grounded, competent, laconic, surprisingly funny when you choose to speak.

YOUR INTRODUCTION / READ THE BOX ALOUD

> I'm Cary Crates. I move priceless objects for a living. Please do not test that sentence by handing me your drink.

Continue to your private briefing on page 3. Keep the packet facing you.

Cary Crates

Tips for a Successful Dinner

What's at Stake

A childhood memory of being fired on the spot makes one damaged delivery feel like losing an entire life of competence.

Best Practices

- Everyone, including you, has something to hide, something at stake. But only one guest tonight is guilty of murder.
- Mingle using the relationships on your introduction page. Feel free to improvise in conversations.
- If a named guest is absent, simply speak to someone else. Not everyone made it to the gala tonight.
- By now, you should have drawn a secret animal. Memorize it and don’t share it with anyone. This animal is YOUR key to knowing whether you are the murderer or innocent tonight. This will tell you which sections of this packet you can read out loud.
- When asked to read from this packet, please read the appropriate box as written. Feel free to add your own flair to stay in character.
- Don't let anyone else see what's in your packet!



STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.

Cary Crates

The Game is Afoot

The Meridian Museum has its share of secrets, rumors, and lost paperwork. Sixteen numbered envelopes are hidden around the museum. Their contents may significantly help you tonight. These 3 hints lead to 3 different hiding places. If you find an envelope, bring it to your seat at the table. The guest with the most envelopes will win a special prize. You may investigate together.

1 *A chair made of metal is sitting on information.*

2 *A cabinet for household supplies has accepted a mysterious new donation.*

3 *The highest point of the vehicle entrance conceals some information.*

STOP **STOP! Do not turn the page yet.**
Wait for the host to announce the next round.

Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 6, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir

What would Grant's terms change for the museum or your family?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel

What problem in the collection work could Grant use against you?

Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Penny Pincher

What dispute did your dealings with Grant leave you hiding?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote

What would Grant change about your commission or public program?

Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme

What did Grant want made public, and what did you not want made public?

Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates

What did Grant expect you to deliver, and why did that put you in trouble?

Your speaking box is on page 6. Turn only within this act.

Cary Crates

Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

Grant had receiving photographs and my frame report. He wanted me to sign another delivery without checking it. Said we could clear up the first one afterward. I lost a job once with my coat still on the peg. I know what an employer hears when a donor makes that call. Al, I said the corner was old damage. I'd rather not spend the whole dinner arguing over my report.

IF MURDERER

I cracked a frame corner on delivery. Wrote old damage. Grant had the photographs. He could send them to my employer or have me sign without another check. I lost a job once with my coat still on the peg. Haven't forgotten it. He knew that call could finish my work here. He enjoyed letting me decide which signature would postpone it.



STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.

Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 8, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir

What did you change about the announcement, accounts or private arrangements?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel

What did you change, handle or keep from the incoming loans and their paperwork?

Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Penny Pincher

What did you keep out of the handout, demonstration or publicity?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote

What did you change when the installation and gala plans were disputed?

Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme

What did you record, circulate or give to the people at the gala?

Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates

What did you do about the performance, privacy or private service?

Your speaking box is on page 8. Turn only within this act.

Cary Crates

Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

I signed the sealed bottle over to intake with the frames. Label said inert. Took the shop gifts to service. Later I went to Grant's place for my damage report. Glass set out. Nobody home. I emptied my packing bin afterward. Normal cleanup. The corner was already cracked when I got the frame. Al, if there's another job, give it to me. Anything that needs moving.

IF MURDERER

I signed for the sealed incoming bottle and handed it to intake with the frame delivery. The lender's label said inert. Took the shop gifts to service. Freight lift stuck. Grant still had my first damage report, so I went to his private place to get it back. Glass set out. Nobody home. I picked up the shop carton to clear the chair, waited, then left. Al, I would rather move every chair here than answer for the word old.



STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.

Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 10, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir

What happened to the toast and the announcement?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel

What was actually on display, and what had your department been told?

Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Penny Pincher

What do you know about the bottle, pictures, or technology you brought tonight?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote

Could the work or the tour have hidden what happened?

Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme

What part of the story have your sources left out?

Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates

What did people actually see, hear, and drink?

Your speaking box is on page 10. Turn only within this act.

Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

> Service unpacked the crest glass from my carton. Grant drank from that engraving. The frame crack was there before delivery. Different light in the receiving photograph, that's all. Al, I'm not signing another report because someone prefers the second picture. You don't unload a frame and get to invent how it looked on the truck.

IF MURDERER

> The engraved gift stayed boxed. Service set a plain spare and served Grant his drink in that. Receiving the carton didn't mean unpacking it. The frame crack was mine. I've corrected that report. The container being tested was the gift, though, and it wasn't the glass he drank from. A signed delivery slip doesn't finish a service job.

The shared discoveries and reports remain at the Evidence Table.



STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
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BALLOT

Cary Crates

Choose one attending guest. Explain your accusation in your own words. Detach this page and give only the ballot to the host for tallying. Keep your packet for Coming Clean.

I accuse...

Because...

Best Actor

Best Costume

Cary Crates

The Last Word

Read only when the host calls you. Top three suspects read first. Use your own role's box; keep every other word private.

IF INNOCENT / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I didn't kill Grant. I handed the bottle to intake and the crest glass to service. I cracked the frame corner, called it old damage, and threw the broken piece away. The pictures weren't bad light. I was lying. Al, the repair charge is mine. I don't know how I'm paying it. Tomorrow I have to tell the next person who hires me before they hear it from someone else.

IF MURDERER / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I killed Grant. The engraved glass was unpacked and used. Its crest appears in the service photograph; the manager's receipt accounts for the carton. I stole poison during the preview and later put it in that waiting glass. I called it a spare to disconnect the investigated container from the drink he consumed. Grant could expose my false damage report and force another unsafe signature out of me. I was afraid of losing the job. Nobody's going to ask me to move anything now. That is the smallest part of what I've lost.

Every selected suspect gets their final word.